

UX REPORT – UDEMY

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

IZ Maduna 22555740
G Mohuba 23545527
TL Mokwena 22496336

IMY 320 GROUP DESIGN A

09 August 2026

1. Introduction

Udemy (udemy.com) is a well-known global online learning marketplace where instructors can offer both paid and free courses on a variety of topics, while learners can easily browse, purchase, and enroll in those courses. We chose Udemy as a reference point for this evaluation because it's a major e-learning platform with a high volume of traffic, and its login, registration, and onboarding processes are utilized by millions of learners. This makes it an excellent benchmark for understanding the conventions that users have come to expect (Nielsen, 2000). Our evaluation is directly tied to the group's brief: before we dive into designing a flexible login-register component that aligns with Jakob's Law, we need to first grasp how well-established platforms like Udemy manage that flow. This way, our design can build on familiar patterns instead of starting from scratch.

2. Methodology

- We utilized a shortened version of the User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S), which was scored using a 7-point semantic differential scale.
- **Participants:**
 - We had 3 individuals per site, referred to as P1, P2, and P3 for anonymity in each group.
- **Pages evaluated:** Landing Page, Login Page, and About Us page
- **Procedure (the same for all three reports):**
 - Open the website
 - Spend about 2-3 minutes exploring the Landing page as well as the About Us page.
 - Navigate to the Login page.
 - Go back to the form and answer the questions
- **Scale:** 7-point semantic differential across 8 criteria:
 - Obstructive – Supportive
 - Complicated – Easy

- Confusing – Clear
- Boring – Exciting
- Conventional – Innovative
- Usual – Modern
- Inefficient – Efficient
- Not Interesting – Interesting

3. Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	22
P2	21
P3	26

4. UEQ Results

4.1 Landing Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	7	5	7	6.3
Complicated-Easy	7	7	6	6.7
Confusing-Clear	7	6	6	6.3
Boring-Exciting	6	7	7	6.7
Conventional-Innovative	6	5	5	5.3
Usual-Modern	6	6	7	6.3
Inefficient-Efficient	7	6	6	6.3
Not Interesting-Interesting	7	6	5	6.0

4.2 Login Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	6	6	7	6.3
Complicated-Easy	7	6	6	6.3
Confusing-Clear	7	6	6	6.3
Boring-Exciting	6	5	7	6.0
Conventional-Innovative	6	5	5	5.3
Usual-Modern	6	5	6	5.7
Inefficient-Efficient	6	5	7	6.0
Not Interesting-Interesting	6	6	6	6.0

4.3 About Us Page

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	6	7	6	6.3
Complicated-Easy	6	7	5	6.0
Confusing-Clear	5	7	6	6.0
Boring-Exciting	6	7	7	6.7
Conventional-Innovative	6	6	6	6.0
Usual-Modern	6	6	7	6.3
Inefficient-Efficient	6	6	6	6.0
Not Interesting-Interesting	6	7	7	6.7

5. Findings

Highest-scoring criterion: Landing page “Complicated-Easy” (6.7), “Boring-Exciting” (6.7) and About Us “Not-Interesting” (6.7), “Boring-Exciting” (6.7) were the top scores overall. Udemy’s landing page stands out with its eye-catching images, easy category browsing, and vibrant promotional banners showcasing sales, ratings, and “bestseller” badges. This lively design probably contributed to its impressive “Exciting” score. Meanwhile, the About Us page earned high marks

for being “Interesting”, likely because Udemy tells its story through the successes of its instructors and learners, using engaging statistics and mission-driven language instead of a dull corporate bio.

Lowest-scoring criterion: “Conventional-Innovative” was consistently the weakest dimension across all three pages (5.3 on Landing page, 5.3 on Login, and 6.0 on About Us). While it never fell below “average”, it also did not manage to impress. Udemy’s login and registration process sticks to traditional format, featuring standard email field, other sign-up/sign-in options, and a familiar course-grid layout. Users are not met with any surprises, which is great for usability but limits novelty scores

When considering **Jakob’s Law**, Udemy’s login and sign-up flow follow a familiar pattern that users are accustomed to seeing on other major platforms. The interface uses a two-column layout, with an illustration positioned on the left and the login or sign-up form on the right. Familiar elements such as the email input, “Continue” button, alternative login/sign-up options, and links for switching between accounts help users navigate the process with minimal effort. This adherence to familiar design is exactly what Jakob's Law suggests will minimize friction (Nielsen, 2000; Wong, 2026), reducing the cognitive effort required to reconcile the interface with users’ existing mental models (Norman, 1988). As a result, participants rated the flow as efficient (with an average score of 6.0) and clear, even though it didn’t shine in the “Innovative” category. This balance is the key challenge our design needs to tackle - maintaining recognizability while still carving out space for a modern feel.

Looking specifically at the login and registration process, Udemy’s login page only asks for an email or offers a “Continue with Google/Facebook/Apple” option for social logins - no extra fields are required at this stage (registration details come later). This approach reduces friction and aligns with the “flexible/generic” quality the client wants to replicate across their other sites.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

To build a reusable, lightweight login solution adaptable to multiple sister sites, we take Jakob's Law (Nielsen, 2000; Mang, 2026) as the core guiding principle, and develop four design rules based on Udemy's platform data:

- Adopt the standard field specifications of email plus password, password reset link, and social login buttons, to match Udemy's efficiency score.
- Move all non-core fields to the registration phase, keep the login process simple to meet the front-end requirements of multiple platforms.
- Set social login as a supplementary option rather than the only login method, to ensure the universality of the process.
- Only inject brand identity into the landing page and the "About Us" section, replicate the high user experience scoring logic of Udemy, and never violate the unified login specifications.

7. Conclusion

Udemy's evaluation reveals that a traditional and familiar login flow performs admirably in terms of efficiency and clarity, but it falls short on the innovation front. This trade-off is a clear example of Jakob's Law in action (Nielsen, 2000; Wong, 2026). For our group's shared redesign of the login and registration process, this suggests that our generic and flexible component should stick to well-established patterns for the login mechanics. We should save any "smart" or "innovative" features for related aspects, like cross-site session handling and adaptive UI, rather than altering the core form fields themselves.

References

Nielsen, J. (2000) Jakob's Law of Internet User Experience [Video]. Nielsen Norman Group. Available at: <https://www.nngroup.com/videos/jakobs-law-internet-ux/> (Accessed: 6 August 2026).

Wong, YL. (2026) 1.3 Jakob's Law and Fitts's Law [Lecture slides]. IMY320, University of Pretoria. Unpublished

Norman, D.A. (1988) The Design of Everyday Things. New York: Basic Books.